

Mike Konczal

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Professional Summary

Accomplished researcher, writer, and advocate skilled in using data and policy analysis to address the economic challenges of our times. I have been cited in over 300 press articles, testified before Congress four times, and made over 50 media appearances on platforms like *CBS Sunday Morning* and *Washington Journal*. My written work has been featured in publications such as *The New York Times* and *The Washington Post*.

Experience

Vice President of Policy and Research, Economic Security Project, Washington, DC 2025–current

- Drive strategy and goal-setting for policy, research, and agenda-setting initiatives, developing and leading efforts on affordability, housing security, and housing policy.
- Manage a policy and research team of five people plus six fellows, supporting the organization's campaigns, organizing, and advocacy efforts at the federal and state level. Produce policy briefs, factsheets, and research projects advancing economic security policy.
- Elevate the visibility of ESP and its partners through dozens of press appearances, media citations, events, and academic discussions. Support fundraising efforts through writing and engagement with funders.

Chief Economist and Special Assistant to the President for Economic Policy, White House National Economic Council, Washington DC 2024

- Provided ongoing economic analysis for the National Economic Advisor and support for NEC Deputy Director for fiscal and macroeconomic policy, including on inflation, growth, employment, tax, budget, and housing policy. Worked closely with colleagues at the Treasury Department and the Council of Economic Advisers.
- Led the formulation of the White House's messaging following all macroeconomic data releases, including themes, statements, charts, and talking points. Tracked the process for data releases, created internal NEC measures, and directed rapid analyses and responses on indicators.
- Amplified the economic messaging of the White House and National Economic Advisor, via speech-writing, content development, and media interaction. Regularly engaged external economic validators, experts, reporters, and academics on economic data as well as the President's agenda.
- Favorably adjudicated Tier 5 investigation; Top Secret/Sensitive Compartmented Information (TS/SCI) clearance granted.

Director, Roosevelt Institute, New York, NY 2010–2023

- Directed the macroeconomic research team, providing original research on key economic issues, including inflation, growth, and employment, at a leading think tank. Served as a go-to expert on economic and policy issues for journalists and policymakers.
- Authored over 20 white papers and edited four comprehensive report volumes. Automated real-time data analysis with R and Python across major data releases.
- Orchestrated four multi-year research and policy initiatives as an expert on topics including the Dodd-Frank Act, the Great Recession, economic inequality, and evolving economic paradigms. Managed teams of two internal researchers and three external fellows.

- Successfully secured and managed research grants from organizations such as the Kauffman, Ford, and Hewlett Foundations, as well as Open Philanthropy.

Financial Engineer, Moody's KMV, San Francisco, CA

2007–2009

- Developed testing benchmarks for Moody's KMV credit risk model, recognized as the 2006 "Top Provider in Trading and Banking" by Risk Magazine. Collaborated on five system releases of RiskFrontier software, developing test cases and acceptance criteria for cutting-edge credit risk modeling algorithms.
- Actively participated in discussions on various approaches to credit risk modeling, focusing on the Vasicek-Kealhofer (VK) model derived from the Black-Scholes-Merton framework. Contributed to debates on capital requirements and loss reserving.
- Prototyped research algorithms using R, SAS, Matlab, and Excel VB to replicate results. Designed and implemented a system that automated the collection, storage, and analysis of significant data sets across four releases, reducing test execution time by 40 percent.

Senior Test Engineer, Motorola, Schaumburg, IL

2001–2005

- Directed performance, load, and stress testing across four major iDEN system releases, earning a Motorola BRAVO Award for "above and beyond performance contribution." Designed automated Six Sigma-level test cases using Perl, Python, and MySQL based on models of consumer behavior. Trained six employees in testing methods.

Education

M.S. Finance, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

2007

- Focus: Graduate-level macro/microeconomics and econometrics ; advanced financial research and option valuation (Monte Carlo, binomial tree) using R, SAS, and C++.

B.A. Mathematics and Computer Science, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

2001

- Focus: Probability, Statistics, Data Structures, Graph Theory, Numerical Methods, and Nonlinear Programming.

Media Appearances and Writings

- Cited in over 300 articles and media references. Top outlets: *New York Times* (32), *Washington Post* (23), *Vox* (21), *Bloomberg* (10), *Business Insider* (9), and more. Over 25 podcast appearances and 15 TV interviews.
- *Freedom From the Market* (New Press, 2021) — named a "Summer Book of 2021" in economics by the *Financial Times*; reviewed in *Democracy Journal*, *Foreign Policy*, *Foreign Affairs*, *Wall Street Journal*, and *National Review*.
- *Rewriting the Rules of the American Economy* (W.W. Norton, 2015) — co-authored with Nobel laureate Joseph Stiglitz.

Skills

R · Python · SAS · MATLAB · LaTeX · Data Visualization · Policy Research · Economic Modeling